politics. The Jana Sangh emerged in 1951 and maintained that name until 1977 when it merged with the anti-Congress multiparty alliance, the Janata Party. In 1980, the Hindu nationalists broke from the Janata Party to become the Bharatiya Janata Party (BJP), which became the first right-wing party to wield power in India.

Like the Swatantra Party, the Jana Sangh and its successors have seen China as a threat, but unlike the Swatantra Party, the Hindu nationalists viewed Pakistan as an equal threat to India's security. According to Howard Erdman, an American political scientist who wrote one of the earliest books on right wing political parties in India: 'The basic instinct of BJS is to be chauvinistic and isolationist, building Indian power and involving India only when she is directly and immediately involved.' [67] While the Jana Sangh sought to be sufficiently distinct from the Congress, in some ways it was closer to specific aspects of Nehruvianism. 'The party's basic instinct is to be "Gaullist" and relatively isolationist,' explained Erdman, adding that for Jana Sangh, Western colonialism and neo-colonialism were not dead issues, nor were some racial considerations. The party accepted non-alignment 'but in a more negative sense', one that 'would still leave India freer to serve as an arbiter or as a third force' in international matters.[68]

A leading stalwart of the Jana Sangh, Atal Bihari Vajpayee, became minister for external affairs during the brief period of non-Congress rule from 1977 to 1980. In his inaugural address in May 1978 to the Foreign Service School, Vajpayee gave a speech titled 'Continuity and Change in India's Foreign Policy'. In the speech Vajpayee asserted that the main purpose of India's foreign policy was 'to promote harmony, trust and a cooperative spirit among nations'. He asserted that India's 'concept of security is not militaristic' but rather the desire to 'create around us an environment of peace, trust, and stability which would permit optimum utilization of our natural and manpower resources for economic, social and cultural advancement.' He stated that his government's policy was 'strict